

YOU HAVE UPHELD THE ORIGINAL FINDING

You are entitled to. Nineteen days of competent police work reached it and nothing in this review is obliged to overturn anything.

But before you sign it, answer the Inspectorate. They asked one question in writing on the very first page of the Case Board and they have not been answered yet.

THE QUESTION YOU HAVE NOT ANSWERED

How did she get in there?

Your finding requires Ines Ballard to be alive and standing at a console at 06:02. Her body was recovered from a sealed concrete gallery, seven metres above a dry sill, downstream of a gate that had been shut since 03:12.

Find the document that says what fills that gallery, and when. Then ask whether a woman at a console at 06:02 could be where she was found at 07:25.

If your answer is that she walked in — check whether the inspection hatch can be opened from the inside, and by whom it was dogged shut, and when.

No score is awarded for this finding. -10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

YOUR ACCUSATION OF DESSA OKONKWO DOES NOT HOLD

She signed for six instruments she never looked at, and a dam has been running blind for five years partly because of it. She will carry that. It is not this.

WHAT YOUR THEORY HAS TO SURVIVE

She was underground, in a confined space, wearing a monitor that transmits every fifteen seconds and alarms after thirty seconds without motion. **Find out when, and find out for how long.** Then put those two intervals against the two moments that matter in this case — and be sure you know what the second of those moments actually is.

If you are still working from the sequence the original file assumed, you will not be able to do this. Establish the sequence first.

No score is awarded for this accusation. –10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

YOUR ACCUSATION OF PIOTR WRENN DOES NOT HOLD

He is the most institutionally motivated man on this site. He signed off an array that does not exist, and a finding of homicide at Ravensgate ends his career either way. If you are looking for someone who needed this buried, you have found him.

He also did not do it, and three separate records say so — **which is exactly why no single one of them cleared him and why nobody has bothered to put them together.**

WHAT YOUR THEORY HAS TO SURVIVE

Three windows, three records, and you need all three:

- Where was he while the gate was open?
- Where was he when the tie was closed at 06:02?
- When was he last inside the room the card was in?

Two answers out of three leaves him a suspect. That is not a flaw in the case; it is what a real alibi looks like when a man spends a night moving about a site.

No score is awarded for this accusation. –10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

CASE REVIEW UNIT

RECONSIDER — ACCUSATION RETURNED

R/MBEKI

OPEN ONLY IF

ACCUSED

YOUR ACCUSATION OF CATO MBEKI DOES NOT HOLD

He was on the other side of a river.

WHAT YOUR THEORY HAS TO SURVIVE

One door. One log. Nine hours. He crossed the footbridge at 21:04 and he crossed back at 06:05, and the only other route was padlocked as part of storm preparation sixteen hours before either death. **Look at the footbridge log again.**

He did get one thing wrong, and it cost this investigation a great deal — but it was a mistake made at two in the morning about a voice on a speaker, and he corrects it the moment anybody asks him properly.

No score is awarded for this accusation. -10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

RECONSIDER · MBEKI

ACCUSATION RETURNED

ENVELOPE S - 1

Case Resolution & Final Summary • Ravensgate

Do not open until the Case Resolution Sheet is complete and the finding is written down and signed.

READING IT

One person reads aloud, in order, without skipping ahead. Pause after each step. Let the table check its own sheet as you go.

There are eight steps and a verdict. Score afterwards, not during.

CASE REVIEW UNIT

RAVENSGATE

STEP 1 · TWO DEATHS, AND ONLY ONE OF THEM HAS A CLOCK

Aurelio Sarn died at 06:03 and nobody has ever doubted it. Ines Ballard drowned, and the Medical Examiner told you in capital letters that no pathologist can say when.

Everything the original investigation concluded followed from filling that gap with an assumption. It assumed she died second, **because the credential evidence implied she did** — and then used the sequence to prove the credential evidence. The file says so itself, in the third bullet of A-1, and nobody read it.

Evidence: B-1, B-2, A-1.

STEP 2 · THE WATER IS THE CLOCK

She was found at trash rack panel 4, at elevation 218.4 metres, inside a sealed concrete gallery.

There are three ways into that gallery and two of them were shut. The inspection hatch was dogged from the outside at 16:40 on the eighteenth and not opened until the recovery team opened it at 07:25. The draft tube ran under vacuum all night, outward and downward. The stoplogs were in.

The only route from the forebay to panel 4 is through intake gate 2, while gate 2 is open and flowing. With the gate shut, the gallery is dry above the sill at 211 metres — and she was seven metres above it.

Intake gate 2 was open **02:31:08 to 03:12:44**. Nothing else, until 08:40.

Ines Ballard entered the water between 02:31 and 03:12, and she has been on that rack ever since.

And if you bought the rack trace, you know it twice over: the debris mat that formed at the 04:12 inflow peak lay **over** her.

Evidence: D-2, D-2A, D-2B, D-1 §2, and SLIP 04.

STEP 3 · A CARD IS NOT A PERSON

Her credential opened cabinet C-14 at 05:47 and closed the F-3 tie at 06:02. She had been dead for about three hours.

Her card was recovered at 10:22 from the second drawer of the control room desk. Not on her body. Not in her locker. In a drawer, 260 metres and two levels from where she was found — and it was on the property schedule the whole time, at line 31, where nobody looked at it because by then everybody knew what had happened.

Standing Order 11.4 says responsibility for a recorded event rests with the holder. That is a rule about discipline. **It was read as a finding of fact, and it is not one.**

Evidence: SLIP 02, C-5A, E-1A.

STEP 4 · WHY A CORRECT ISOLATION KILLED HIM

Aurelio Sarn did everything right.

He isolated feeder F-5, applied his own padlock, hung his tag, and proved the circuit dead with a tester this department has since checked and found accurate. The cabinet was dead when he opened it.

It was fed by a second circuit. **Feeder F-3** — certified permanently decommissioned and physically removed in 2019, under contract RG-0419, and never touched. Still there. Still live. Still switchable from the control room. And **erased from the as-built drawing at revision C in 2019 by the same man who signed the certificate.**

The drawing in the control room — the one an engineer reads before he isolates — showed C-14 as single-fed. It was that drawing that killed him, three and a half years after it was amended.

Evidence: E-6, SLIP 07, E-2A.

STEP 5 · WHO COULD HAVE USED HER CARD

The control room door did not open between 02:29:55 and 05:44:03.

Three hours and fourteen minutes, one door, badge-controlled both ways, fire escape alarmed and silent. Halloran Vey went in at 21:57 and did not come out. Nobody else went in. Her lanyard was in the desk.

And the F-3 tie was not closed from some anonymous terminal. The log says where: **console 1.**

Evidence: E-1, D-1 §1, D-1A.

STEP 6 · THE TWENTY-SIX MINUTES

His alibi was true, and total, and that is why it took a review to break it.

He logged on to console 1 at 21:58 and off at 07:41 — a single unbroken session of nine hours and forty-three minutes, no lock events, no second operator. Every record on the site says Halloran Vey was at his desk.

Except the one that actually checks. Storm-mode alarms escalate after ninety seconds unacknowledged. Across the entire night there is **one** gap:

02:38 to 03:04. Eleven alarms escalate, unanswered.

At **03:05:12**, all eleven are cleared in **thirty-eight seconds** — the rate of a man sitting back down.

Control room to forebay parapet: **four minutes.** There and back with eighteen minutes to spare.

He opened gate 2 at 02:31. He stood up at 02:38. She went into the water at about 02:50 and the gate he had opened carried her inside. He sat down at 03:04, cleared his screen, and shut the gate at 03:12.

A session log records that a session is open. Only the alarms record whether anybody is in the chair.

Evidence: SLIP 01, against his own account at C-1 and the session record at D-1A.

STEP 7 · THE CLEARED

Cato Mbeki crossed the footbridge at 21:04 and back at 06:05. One door, one log, nine hours, and the service tunnel padlocked since the afternoon. (E-1)

Dessa Okonkwo was underground on permits 1144 and 1145, wearing a monitor transmitting every fifteen seconds, unbroken 02:12–03:40 and 05:35–06:25 — which covers both the gate window and the switching. Against the sequence the file assumed, that clears her of nothing. (C-3A)

Piotr Wrenn was out of the control room after 01:58, at the van keyboard at 02:34 and 02:51, and on a recorded satellite call from 05:58 to 06:14. **Three records, three windows, and no two of them are enough.** (SLIP 09)

Ines Ballard was in the water. (D-2A, D-1 §2)

STEP 8 · WHY

\$186,000, through a company registered to his wife, from the only client it ever had.

Contract RG-0419 had two scopes. Install six foundation piezometers. Remove one legacy feeder. Thennick Instrumentation delivered a junction box and some cable, invoiced \$1.41 million, and did neither. Halloran Vey certified both complete, and within nine days of each certification Ashgrove Technical Services invoiced Thennick for advisory work of which no trace has ever been produced.

For five years he generated the readings himself. The dam's actual foundation pore pressures are unknown and have been unknown since 2019, and the station is now under a Section 10 direction while somebody finds out.

At half past one in the morning, in a storm, Ines Ballard noticed that six numbers were not moving with a reservoir that had come up a third of a metre.

Evidence: SLIP 06, SLIP 11, E-2, E-2A.

DOUBLE UNLAWFUL KILLING

HALLORAN VEY

Ines Ballard is exonerated.

WHAT HAPPENED

They went down forty-one steps at ten past two and opened a junction box and there was nothing in it. At twenty-five past, Sarn told him it was going to the regulator at first light — and the young man across the river heard two angry voices over a keyed radio and assumed, because it was two in the morning, that the second one was hers.

At 02:31 he opened a gate. It was a defensible operation and the Inspectorate has confirmed as much; passing water at 126 cumecs before a peak is exactly what the manual says. It was also a route out of the valley that runs through a concrete gallery, and he knew it, because he had spent eleven years watching that station take in everything that floated.

At 02:38 he stood up. She was crossing the crest to the site office for the as-built drawings — the drawings he had amended in 2019 — and he met her on the way.

Then he came back, cleared eleven alarms in thirty-eight seconds, shut the gate, and worked through the rest of the storm. At twenty to six he told a man he had known for a decade that there was an earth fault on F-5, and watched him go and do everything correctly.

He was undone by an alarm system counting to ninety.

SCORE THE FILE, NOT THE GUESS

Award only for what was written on the Resolution Sheet before the final accusation. **Steps ticked S≤3 — established on the Case Board before the end of Session 3 — score double.**

ITEM	BASE	S≤3	SCORED
Finding recorded as double unlawful killing	+5	—	
Correct culprit named — Vey	+10	—	
Step 1 · Both causes of death, cited	+5	+10	
Step 2 · Ballard in the water 02:31–03:12, by the gate argument	+5	+10	
Step 3 · A credential event is not a person, cited	+5	+10	
Step 4 · F-3, undocumented and undecommissioned, cited	+5	+10	
Step 5 · Control room sole occupancy 02:29–05:44, cited	+5	+10	
Step 6 · The 02:38–03:04 acknowledgement gap, cited	+5	+10	
Ines Ballard exonerated with evidence	+10	—	
Mbeki cleared with evidence	+5	—	
Okonkwo cleared with evidence	+5	—	
Wrenn cleared — all three records cited	+5	—	
Motive established	+5	—	
Each wrong accusation	–10	—	
Clean Sweep — six steps, four persons resolved, correct first time	+15	—	
Each unspent authority	+2	—	
TOTAL			

FINDINGS OF THE REVIEW

SCORE	OUTCOME
100+	COMMENDATION. Charged, and the file will survive anything a defence barrister does to it.
75–99	CHARGED. The right man, and enough working to justify it.
50–74	REFERRED. The Crown will take it. Ms Ballard's name is cleared, which was the more urgent thing.
25–49	OPEN VERDICT. The original finding is quashed and nothing replaces it. Better than nothing, and not by much.
<25	THE FINDING STANDS.

IF YOU UPHELD MURDER-SUICIDE

Then the file closes as it closed before, Halloran Vey retires on a full pension, and Ines Ballard remains, on the public record, a woman who killed her manager and drowned herself in a reservoir. Score it honestly and sit with it for a moment. Every step of the original reasoning was sound; it simply began from something nobody had checked.

TWO QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING AFTERWARDS

1. How many Sessions passed before the hydrology file was tabled? That number is the case.
2. Was holding a file better than sharing everything, as in Case 01 — or did it just mean four people waited while one person read? Say so out loud. That answer decides whether this mechanic survives.